

Letter of Explanation: Master Template Pack

Eight professionally structured LOE templates for the most common explanation scenarios in Express Entry files - each with usage guidance and an annotation on exactly what the reviewing officer is looking for.

How to use an LOE - the four-part structure

A Letter of Explanation is not an apology and not an essay. Every effective LOE does four things in under a page: **(1) names the specific issue** an officer would notice, **(2) states the facts** with dates, **(3) points to enclosed evidence** item by item, and **(4) closes** without pleading. Attach it in the slot IRCC provides (or merged with the related document), one issue per letter.

The golden rule

Never explain what needs no explanation - an unnecessary LOE invites scrutiny of a non-issue. Write one only when a reasonable officer, reading your file cold, would pause and ask a question. Then answer exactly that question.

Template 1 - Employment gap

When to use it

Use when there is any period in your work history not covered by employment - between jobs, after graduation, or during a career break.

What the officer is looking for

Officers are not penalising the gap itself; they are checking that the timeline is complete and honest. An unexplained hole invites speculation - a declared, dated, evidenced gap closes the question.

Template

Subject: Letter of Explanation - Employment gap, [start month year] to [end month year]

Dear Officer,

I am writing regarding the period between [date] and [date], during which I was not employed.

During this period I was [reason: caring for a family member / completing a professional certification / relocating and conducting a job search / recovering from illness]. I have declared this period in my application in the personal history section.

Supporting evidence enclosed:

1. [e.g. Course enrolment and completion certificate]
2. [e.g. Medical documentation covering the period]
3. [e.g. Travel records confirming relocation dates]

My employment before this period ended on [date] ([employer]), and my subsequent employment began on [date] ([employer]), as confirmed by the reference letters enclosed with this application. No work experience points are claimed for the gap period.

Sincerely,

[Full name as in passport] - [UCI / application number]

Template 2 - Travel history discrepancy

When to use it

Use when passport stamps, visas, or records show travel that does not obviously match your declared address or personal history.

What the officer is looking for

The officer's concern is completeness of your travel and address history. Reconcile each specific trip to a line in your form - do not write generally about being a frequent traveller.

Template

Subject: Letter of Explanation - Travel history clarification

Dear Officer,

I write to clarify the following entries in my travel history that may appear inconsistent with my declared address history.

1. [Country], [dates] - [purpose: short business trip]. My residential address remained [address], as this visit was under [n] weeks.
2. [Country], [dates] - [purpose]. This trip is reflected in the stamps on passport [number], page [n].

My address history in the application lists only residences of 6 months or longer, per the form instructions; the trips above were shorter stays and did not change my residential address.

Supporting evidence enclosed:

1. Passport pages showing entry/exit stamps
2. [Flight itineraries / visa copies / employer travel letter]

Sincerely,

[Full name as in passport] - [UCI / application number]

Template 3 - Study-to-work transition

When to use it

Use when your first skilled role began soon after graduation and the early employment overlaps study, or your job preceded the credential officers would expect it to require.

What the officer is looking for

The officer needs the sequence to make sense: what was studied, when it ended, when the work began, and whether any overlap was permitted (e.g. part-time work as a student, or a role obtained before convocation).

Template

Subject: Letter of Explanation - Study-to-work transition timeline

Dear Officer,

I write to clarify the relationship between my education and early employment.

I completed the final requirements of my [credential] at [institution] on [date], with the degree formally conferred on [convocation date]. I accepted an offer from [employer] on [date] and began work on [date].

[If overlapping: Between [date] and [date] I worked part-time ([n] hours/week) while completing my studies, which was permitted under [basis]. No skilled work experience points are claimed for this period.]

Work experience points in this application are claimed only from [date], when I began full-time employment as [job title].

Supporting evidence enclosed:

1. Final transcript showing completion date
2. Degree certificate / provisional certificate
3. Offer letter and first appointment letter from [employer]

Sincerely,

[Full name as in passport] - [UCI / application number]

Template 4 - Large or recent deposit in proof of funds

When to use it

Use when your bank balance shows a significant deposit in the 6-month window that could look like borrowed or parked money.

What the officer is looking for

Unexplained spikes are one of the most common proof-of-funds refusal triggers. The officer needs the source, the paper trail, and confirmation the money is genuinely yours and non-repayable.

Template

Subject: Letter of Explanation - Source of funds, deposit of [amount] on [date]

Dear Officer,

My bank statement for [bank, account ending ####] shows a deposit of [amount] on [date]. I write to document its source.

The funds originate from [source: sale of property at [address] / maturity of fixed deposit [number] / gift from [name, relationship]].

Paper trail enclosed:

1. [Sale deed / FD maturity advice / notarized gift deed stating the funds are non-repayable]
2. [Buyer's/donor's bank statement showing the outgoing transfer]
3. [Bank advice slip confirming the credit]

These funds are unencumbered, held in my own name, and remain available for settlement in Canada. The 6-month statements enclosed show all other balances arise from my declared salary of [amount]/month from [employer].

Sincerely,
[Full name as in passport] - [UCI / application number]

Template 5 - Name variation across documents

When to use it

Use when documents show different spellings, orderings, or forms of your name (or a maiden name / single-name passport).

What the officer is looking for

Officers must be certain every document belongs to the same person. List each variant, say which documents carry it, and anchor everything to the passport name.

Template

Subject: Letter of Explanation - Name variation across documents

Dear Officer,

My name appears in the following variations across my documents:

1. [Name exactly as in passport] - passport, this application
2. [Variant] - [documents: degree certificate, transcripts]
3. [Variant] - [documents: earlier employment letters]

All variants refer to me. The variation arises from [reason: transliteration practice / maiden name before marriage on [date] / initial-expanded form customary in [country]].

Supporting evidence enclosed:

1. [Affidavit of one and the same person / gazette notification]
2. [Marriage certificate linking former and current names]

I request that all enclosed documents be read under my passport name, [full name].

Sincerely,
[Full name as in passport] - [UCI / application number]

Template 6 - Police certificate not yet received

When to use it

Use when a required police certificate cannot arrive before your 60-day submission deadline.

What the officer is looking for

IRCC's own guidance is to submit proof that you ordered the certificate. Show the order date, the authority's stated processing time, and commit to uploading on arrival.

Template

Subject: Letter of Explanation - Police certificate from [country] pending

Dear Officer,

My application requires a police certificate from [country], where I resided from [date] to [date]. I applied for this certificate on [application date] - before receiving my ITA / immediately upon receiving my ITA - and it has not yet been issued.

The issuing authority ([name]) states a current processing time of [n weeks/months]. Enclosed as proof of my request:

1. Application receipt / acknowledgment dated [date]
2. Payment confirmation
3. [Correspondence with the authority]

I will upload the certificate to my account immediately upon receipt. I respectfully request that my application be processed in the interim.

Sincerely,
[Full name as in passport] - [UCI / application number]

Template 7 - NOC duties clarification

When to use it

Use when your job title does not obviously match the NOC code claimed, or a reference letter's wording could read as a different TEER level.

What the officer is looking for

The officer cross-references your letter's duties against the NOC lead statement and main duties. Map your actual duties to the NOC's language explicitly - title is irrelevant, duties decide.

Template

Subject: Letter of Explanation - NOC [code] classification for role at [employer]

Dear Officer,

My position at [employer] carries the internal title [title]. I have classified this role under NOC [code] ([NOC title]) based on duties actually performed, as detailed in the enclosed reference letter.

Mapping of my duties to NOC [code] main duties:

1. NOC: [main duty from canada.ca] - My role: [matching duty from reference letter]
2. NOC: [main duty] - My role: [matching duty]
3. NOC: [main duty] - My role: [matching duty]

The internal title reflects [company naming convention]; the substance of the role is that of [NOC title]. My reporting line, [qualification requirements], and salary band enclosed further support this level.

Sincerely,
[Full name as in passport] - [UCI / application number]

Template 8 - Common-law relationship evidence

When to use it

Use when declaring a common-law partner and your cohabitation evidence needs context (different lease names, periods apart, family-owned housing).

What the officer is looking for

Common-law status requires 12 continuous months of cohabitation in a conjugal relationship (declared on IMM 5409). Officers look for layered, dated evidence; explain any document that seems to point the other way.

Template

Subject: Letter of Explanation - Common-law cohabitation evidence

Dear Officer,

[Partner name] and I have cohabited continuously as a couple since [date], as declared in our statutory declaration (IMM 5409). I write to give context to our supporting evidence.

1. [Lease is in one name only because the building required a single leaseholder; enclosed letter from the landlord confirms joint occupancy since [date].]
2. [Between [date] and [date], I travelled for work ([n] weeks); our shared residence and relationship continued, as shown by ongoing joint expenses during that period.]

Evidence enclosed:

1. IMM 5409 statutory declaration, sworn [date]
2. Joint [bank account / utility bills / insurance] from [date]
3. Correspondence addressed to both of us at [address]
4. [Photographs, travel bookings, and declarations from family]

Sincerely,

[Full name as in passport] - [UCI / application number]

Final checks before you attach any LOE

☐	One issue per letter - never combine unrelated explanations
☐	Every date in the letter matches the application forms exactly
☐	Every piece of evidence named in the letter is actually enclosed
☐	No speculation, no emotion, no filler - facts, dates, documents
☐	Signed, with your full passport name and UCI/application number
☐	Under one page wherever possible

Sources

Every rule and figure in this document was verified against the following official pages on 19 July 2026:

- canada.ca/en/immigration-refugees-citizenship/services/immigrate-canada/express-entry/apply-permanent-residence.html
- canada.ca/en/immigration-refugees-citizenship/services/immigrate-canada/express-entry/documents/police-certificates.html
- canada.ca/en/immigration-refugees-citizenship/services/immigrate-canada/express-entry/documents/proof-funds.html

Important - please read

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